

NEC MultiSync LCD 1560v

Slim and speakerless

The NEC 1560v is a flat panel LCD monitor with a black frame and compact design. It doesn't have in-built speakers. The Auto option in the OSD menu



automatically adjusts the monitor's refresh rate, and wraps the screen to the raster. The buttons are placed on the bottom edge, and are inconvenient to access.

We ran several test slides from DisplayMate Video Edition to check the monitor's performance under extreme conditions. It scored well in almost all the tests. The focus and resolution was very good

Price: Rs 20,500
Contact: Shiba Comp Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-2743 0278
E-mail: shiba@del2.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.nec.com

with just a little Red, Green or Blue visible at the edges, though there was a little streaking. The monitor has uniform brightness, even when viewed at 1024 x 768. It has a fine dot pitch of 0.297 mm. The screen is mildly reflective, which causes eye strain when the display is dark.

This monitor, like all LCDs, is more suited to offices where space is a scarce resource. If price is a worry, bulk buys are eligible for discounts.



SPECIFICATIONS

Contrast ratio 400:1, brightness: 250cd/m2, max resolution: 1024 x 768 at 60 Hz, weight: 5.5 Kgs, 0.297 mm dot pitch

NEC MultiSync LCD 1560v		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	

Creative Sound Blaster External USB Sound System

A moving sound system

Creative has come out with yet another external USB sound device, targeted at those who want a quick and easy sound upgrade. This small device comes with a



clip and Velcro strips to attach the device to your laptop or desktop. Other accessories include a USB cable and a 'Y' splitter cable.

The sound chip supports EAX, for environmental sound effects. It has audio Line-In and Line-Out ports for stereo or 2.1 channel sound, and also

supports 5.1 and 6.1 channel sound and external optical devices via its Optical-Out and Optical-In ports. The product comes with an installation CD that contains drivers and Creative Media Source software, with virtual surround and a 10-band graphic equalizer.

The sound card can be set up in seconds—just connect the USB cable and install the driver. The output is a little low on treble, but the bass is good due to the bass boost.

Price: Rs 4,299
Contact: Creative Labs Asia
Phone: 98203-57713
E-mail: rajshekhar_bhatt@ctl.creative.com
Web site: www.creative.com

At Rs 4,300, this device gives you the advantage of portability and simplicity. However, we recommend this only to laptop users, as desktop users can get a better sound card for the same price.

SPECIFICATIONS

USB 1.1 interface, analog line-out, headphone output, SPDIF optical output, analog-digital output selector, mic input

Creative Sound Blaster External USB Sound System		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	

Samsung DVD HDD Recorder DVD-H40S

Move away VCR

The DVD equivalent to a VCR—the Samsung DVD-H40S can play DVDs as well as store programs, images, etc., on its in-built hard disk. It can record programs from television broadcasts, or media files from DVDs and CDs on its 40 GB hard disks.

It has a friendly GUI. You can only choose between two storage modes—40 hours of video, 250 MP3s and 10,000 JPG images, or 30 hours of video, 2500 MP3s and 10,000 JPG images. It comes with a huge full-function remote that needs both hands to control it.

The DVD-H40S is a great advantage over conventional VCRs—you can record a series of TV programmes, and start watching stuff while it's still recording. Videos can be

Price: Rs 44,990
Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd
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recorded at 2, 4 and 6 Mbps. The video output is excellent, and it has optical and co-axial digital output ports, as well as input ports for devices such as a camcorder, VCD, VCR and sound system. The only drawback was the lack of CD- or DVD- writing support, and an interface to transfer data to and from a PC—which one would expect at Rs 45,000.

SPECIFICATIONS

DVD, VCD, MP3 and CD playback, Dolby Digital and DTS support, 40 GB hard disk, video-in/out jacks, Component Video Out jacks, S-video In-Out jacks, one Digital Optical Audio Out, one Digital Co-axial Audio Out, RF antenna input and output

Samsung DVD HDD Recorder DVD-H40S		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	